

◀ MUGHAL CHARGE

The armoured cavalry of Mughal ruler Akbar the Great charges its enemies in the 1560s, using swords and lances. Akbar was fond of war elephants, with 5,000 in his army, although they are reputed to have been panicked by gunpowder weapons.

KEY EVENTS

1500s–1700s

■ **1514–17** Ottoman Turks defeat the Persian Safavids at Chaldiran, and the Egyptian Mamluks at Raydaniya, exploiting the use of gunpowder weapons against opponents who lack them.

■ **1526** Led by Babur, the Mughals defeat the Sultan of Delhi at the battle of Panipat, their cannon terrifying the Sultan's force of war elephants.

■ **1571** Ottoman war galleys, short of gunpowder weapons, are defeated by a Christian fleet at Lepanto (see pp.154–55).

■ **1587** In Persia, Shah Abbas I begins a successful modernization of the Safavid armed forces, employing European military experts.

■ **1658–1707** The Mughal Empire reaches its greatest extent under the rule of Aurangzeb, gradually declining after his death.

■ **1683** The Ottoman defeat at the Siege of Vienna marks the beginning of a sharp and irreversible decline in the success of the Ottoman army.

